

The Unvarnished Truth About Small-Te

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Most small teams successfully ship for 6-18 months. Then, as user count or feature count triples, their informal patterns fail: deployment conflicts rise, database migrations take minutes, and the "one person knows X" problem cascades. At that point, they either hire deliberately to rebuild foundations, or they pivot to a new product. The honest conclusion: small-team shipping is not a sustainable model for mission-critical, high-compliance, or 24/7 systems. It is, however, the fastest way to discover product-market fit--and that discovery is almost always worth the subsequent rebuild.